TRUNKBELAY · DESIGN DECISION RECORD

TrunkBelay design for construction

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/trunkbelay		
Source	docs/decisions/0002-design-for-construction.md @ b6393c7		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Concept made constructable; changes C1 to C11 and assumptions A1 to A6 decided under Amish's 2026-10-03 pre-approvals

0002: Design for construction

- **Date:** 2026-10-03
- **Status:** decided. Decided by Amish under his pre-approval of 2026-10-03: "start with the first 14 repos from the list of 29 projects. I pre-approve the batch runs along with any recommendations you come up with. I also accept any cost overruns or variations from the assumed scope cost." and his instruction of the same day: "Proceed with the remaining 15 scaffolds". Design-for-construction rule, Amish, 2026-09-30: "fix the design assumptions to match and be physically feasible."

Context

The TRL 2 concept (TKB-DDR-001) named the parts but not how each is made or joined: a "chain collar", a "slotted cleat", a "padded bearing plate" and a friction device "on the collar". STANDARDS section 18 requires every part to be makeable by a stated process and to fit and fasten to its neighbours. The parametric model (`cad/src/model.py`) was built part by part, and its 210 constructability checks (contact, clearance, the trunk, the chain in its slots and the pad contact point, each on 200, 300 and 450 mm trunks) all pass. None of the changes alters what the kit does, its pitch or its safety case; each is the simplest physically sound way to make a concept part.

Changes

Table 1. Changes from the concept to the constructable design.

#	Component	The concept had	The constructable design has	Why
C1	Bark bearing	A padded curved plate	Two 50 x 25 x 2.5 mm steel box bars in a 120 deg V, each faced with a 10 mm rubber pad, bonded and held by two countersunk M6 screws	Fits 200 to 450 mm trunks; a box bar carries the pad force with a factor of 2.1 on yield at 2.5 kN (TKB-CAL-001, C1)
C2	Frame	Not defined	One 5 mm steel spine plate carrying the bars at its foot, the chain slots at its top and two eyes at its outer end	One plate ties every load together; 5 mm because a 6 mm chain link must span the web
C3	Cleat	A slotted cleat	Two 7.5 mm slots cut in the spine top, with a 6 mm cheek welded on each face, notched round each slot	The chain pulls across the plate; the cheeks stop the thin top twisting (C4 factor 3.1 and 3.8) and the notches let the links bear on the web
C4	Lock	Not defined	A keeper bent from 3 mm sheet, its bridge over both slot mouths, held by an 8 mm ball-lock pin through its legs, the cheeks and the web	A link cannot lift out of its slot; one pin to check
C5	Fixed chain end	Not defined	Also in a slot (the front one), its tail tied to the spare eye with an 8 mm quick link	The chain can be adjusted from either end and cannot be dropped when the keeper is off
C6	Eyes	"On the collar"	Two 22 mm eyes with a 4 mm doubler ring welded each side, edges rounded: 13 mm of rounded steel under a carabiner	A carabiner must never bear on a thin plate edge
C7	Lever	Not defined	The load eye 150 mm out from the spine's front edge; the chain line 160 mm above the frame foot	Gives a locking factor of 1.54 or more on every trunk (TKB-CAL-001, B4)
C8	Chain	"Short length of alloy chain"	6 mm grade 80, 110 links, master link and connecting link on the adjustable end; painted links mark the slot link for 200, 300 and 450 mm trunks	Fits the full trunk range with at least 10 links of tail; factor 8.1 on breaking force
C9	Chain padding	The plate "stops the chain biting in"	600 mm of 50 mm tubular webbing on the chain at the back of the trunk	Spreads the chain's pressure where it is highest (0.6 MPa at 2.5 kN)
C10	Brake	A friction device	Auto-locking descender on the load eye, brake strand turned 180 deg over a carabiner in the spare eye	Brings the hand force from about 150 N to about 80 N (TKB-CAL-001, D1)
C11	Finish	Not defined	Frame hot-dip galvanised after welding, vent holes in the bars, slots and pin hole cleared afterwards; load and one-person marking stamped on the spine	Rust-proof in the open in a monsoon climate

Assumptions decided

Table 2. Assumptions behind the constructable design.

#	Assumption	Value	Relaxed or tightened by
A1	Friction on wet coconut bark	Rubber pad 0.5, webbing-sleeved chain 0.4, together 0.9	Slip tests on cut trunk sections at TRL 4; the design needs 0.58 on a 200 mm trunk
A2	Pad rubber	60 to 70 Shore A, effective compression modulus 6 MPa	The rubber bought
A3	Descender	Rope friction 0.2 over 540 deg of contact, ratio 6.6	The maker's data for the descender bought
A4	Rope stretch	4 % between 50 and 150 kg (EN 1891 type A class)	The rope bought
A5	Bark	No cut at 2 MPa under rubber or 0.6 MPa under webbing; bare links may mark it	Inspection after the TRL 4 tests (R8)
A6	Trunk range	200 to 450 mm, round enough for a V to touch on two lines	A survey of palms with the first co-design candidate

Consequences

- Every part is cut, drilled, bent or welded from plate, box section and sheet, or bought; the frame is one welded, galvanised piece of about 2.3 kg of steel.
- The collar (frame and chain set) weighs 4.4 kg and the kit 8.9 kg; the kit mass is open in TKB-DEC-001, O3.
- The general arrangement TKB-DWG-001, the making sketches TKB-DWG-101 to 109 and the build plan TKB-BLD-001 show this design.

> **Safety:** These changes make the collar buildable; they do not make it safe to use on a person. The build plan's safety stops require a proof test of the collar at 2.5 kN on cut trunk sections and a dummy drill at low height before anyone is lowered with it.